



University of New Hampshire at Manchester
American Sign Language III
Fall 2023 Syllabus



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Course/Credits: ASL 531 - M1: 4 credits
Classroom: Tuesday/Thursday: 4:10 pm – 6:00 pm
Lecturer: Jotham Otterson
Office: Room 354
Email: Jotham.Otterson@unh.edu

Classroom Lab: Wednesdays: 3:10pm – 4:00pm
ASL Lab Instructor: Michaela Borstel
Email: borstelm@gnmhc.org

Course Description

Continuation of ASL 436 and expansion on concepts and principles. Focus on more advanced vocabulary and patterns of grammar, use of space and modulation of signs to denote aspects of time and location, and additional information on Deaf culture. A weekly one-hour language laboratory is required as part of this course. Pre-req: ASL 436 or program evaluation. Limited to 15 students. No credit if credit has been received for COMM 733.

Course Level Outcomes

Upon successful completion of this course, students will:

1. Vocabulary Development

- a. Recognize and produce vocabulary items in each unit.
- b. Demonstrate comprehensive mastery of targeted vocabulary words drawn from class items, lectures, and videos.

2. Grammatical Features

- a. Demonstrate comprehensive mastery of target, content-specific commands, questions, and statements in ASL.
- b. Identify grammatical features within short dialogues in ASL directed by the professor.

3. Conversational and Communication Skills

- a. Demonstrate comprehension and conversation facilitating behaviors.
- b. Demonstrate comprehension and production of regulating behaviors (i.e. attention-getting techniques, turn-taking signals, and others)
- c. Comprehend short narratives and stories in ASL signed by the professor, Deaf ASL speakers, or ASL videos added by the professor.
- d. Demonstrate the ability to create, conduct and terminate a short content-specific conversation.

4. Cultural Awareness

- a. Analyze and critique competing perspectives of diverse Deaf Communities in the United States and Canada, ideas, aesthetic traditions, and cultural practices, and its history.
- b. Compare, contrast, and interpret differences and commonalities among Deaf and hearing cultures.
- c. Demonstrate the ability to reflect on and learn from classroom instruction and activities, fellow students, Deaf community members, and demonstrate a clear understanding of the fluency, attitudes, and beliefs required to be a successful second language learner in a global society



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Required Texts & Materials

- True+Way ASL- Unit 9-12→ Registration through Canvas.
- GoReact- Registration through GoReact.com.
- Seeing Voices by Oliver Sacks (copies will be provided)

Recommended websites (no charge)

- English-to-ASL Dictionary, <http://lifeprint.com/dictionary.htm>
- Spread the sign, <http://www.spreadthesign.com/us/>

Handouts as assigned

- Students must use their **UNH email account only** for this class; if you do not have one, please see the Registration Office ASAP.
- **GoReact access** will be used in this class via canvas for uploading sign production videos and receiving evaluation on your ASL production in the ASL/English Interpreting Lab.

TEACHING / LEARNING PHILOSOPHY

ASL Zone/Total Language Immersion: Because this course is being taught solely in American Sign Language (ASL), it is expected that you are to try to think and communicate only in ASL. This method is merely for you to excel. (Spoken English can be used only before class, during short break, and after class.) Please refrain from using spoken English in the class and respect your classmates who are trying to think and communicate in ASL only. Your support for your classmates, and mainly for yourself, in communication activities without vocal distractions (e.g., whispering) will be greatly appreciated. In the long run, you will find it very helpful. For continuous infractions of this simple rule, the teacher reserves the right to ask you to leave the classroom temporarily, until you are ready to comply with this Total Language Immersion goal.

COURSE REQUIREMENTS

ASL Language Laboratory: The ASL Language Laboratory is an excellent way to try out and practice different grammatical features and conversational skills you have learned in class, without fear of making errors. Various fun-filled natural communication activities and drills will be used to support you. PLEASE READ THE “ASL LAB RULES” via canvas.

Attendance/Participation: Attendance and participation in ASL classes or online and the ASL Language Laboratory or online are very important due to the visual nature of the language, not often found outside the classroom on the campus. Therefore, up to two (2) absences is acceptable, but each class absence above two absences will lower a student’s grade by part of a letter grade (e.g., A to A-; A- to B+, etc.) If you arrive in class after attendance has been taken, it will be your responsibility to report your arrival to your instructor at break time.

If you miss class due to compelling, non-academic circumstances, you can submit medical documentation to Stephanie Kirylych, Director of Academic Advising, at stephanie.kirylych@unh.edu. Stephanie will evaluate your documentation and, if compelling, notify me that a documented situation impacted your attendance. Once notified by Academic Advising, I will determine if an excused absence or other course accommodation is reasonable. Students should never submit medical documentation directly to course instructors.



Participation:

You are strongly encouraged to participate in one of the following three ways:

- a) Signing in ASL
- b) Using gestures and/or
- c) Typing on devices or writing on the piece of paper or on the board if you don't know the particular ASL signs.

During each class, you will be given tasks that will help you try out your newly acquired communicative skills with your class peers. You are encouraged to participate with your classmates and ask your instructor questions during that time. **Please do not use your voice during the class.** Errors in signing and grammar made during class will not negatively affect your grade. Your grade on your ASL fluency is based solely on tests and quizzes. Tests and quizzes will be used as a measure of your accomplishment in ASL for this course.

NOTE: All written assignments will be submitted to Canvas and ASL Presentations will be submitted via GoReact

Course Grading System

Your comprehension and production skills will be evaluated regularly throughout the course in different ways as listed below.

Deaf Culture 5%

Quizzes are designed to cover from the reading chapters, and will have 10 multiply choices in each chapter.

Conversation Starter Discussions 5%

Watch the conversation starters. Pick a question to answer and type your response in the discussion board by the due date. Once you type your response, you will be able to see your classmates' responses. Feel free to post additional questions and comments to better understand the conversation starters.

Worksheets 20%

Worksheets are designed to retain and reinforce what is learned in the classroom/Zoom. Complete the assigned workbook assignments by assigned due dates.

Quizzes 10%

Quizzes are designed to cover content previously learned to ensure you are on the right pace in learning the material. Complete the assigned quizzes by the due dates.

Peer Observation Assignment (POA) 5%

At the end of each unit, you will be watching videos of proficient Deaf ASL signers signing something incorrectly. Try to identify the error by answering the questions by the due date.

Self-Observation Assessment Review (SOAR) 10%

At the end of each unit, you are to sign sentences in ASL. You are to record your work and submit your video by the due date. Complete the rubric by comparing your video with the proficient Deaf ASL signer, identifying areas you can improve and areas that you are doing well.



Story Comprehension 5%

At the end of each unit, you will watch a story and answer questions about the story by the due date. Also, the test will cover material presented up to this point in the course. They will include information from the lectures, vocabulary, conversation starter discussions, worksheets, and quizzes.

Unit Comprehension Test 15% & Unit Production Test 25%

The test will cover material presented up to this point in the course. They will include information from the lectures, vocabulary, conversation starter discussions, worksheets, and quizzes.

Grading Criteria

ASL/English Interpreting Program's Grading System:

<u>Points</u>	<u>Grade</u>	<u>Points</u>	<u>Grade</u>
94↑	A	74↑	C
90↑	A-	70↑	C-
87↑	B+	67↑	D+
84↑	B	64↑	D
80↑	B-	60↑	D-
77↑	C+	<60	F

Units Sign Production Video Assignments: You will sign your Units 5 to 8 sign production video assignments in ASL on video outside of class during your own time as an at-home assignment. The video will have to be uploaded into [GoReact.com](https://www.goreact.com), in order for your ASL professor to evaluate your sign production in these units' video assignments.

Good quality of video is needed in these video assignments. Video assignments that contain choppy or delayed footage will not be accepted by your professor.

- Videos cannot be choppy and delayed
- Videos are required to have good lighting

Practice in the Lab is not allowed, because you are expected to be ready before coming into the Lab. You will be video recorded on GoReact while you are signing your story. The purpose of these story signing assignments is to develop some ASL skills such as shoulder-shifting, eye gaze, role-shifting, space usage, non-manual signals, descriptions and vocabulary. **Video screen visibility needs to be about a foot above your head to your waist on the video.**

Cellphone and all of your personal items have to be left outside of the Lab when you are signing the stories inside the Lab due to distraction. The videos will be saved online and sent to your professor via GoReact. No USB flash drives or memory cards are needed. Due dates are shown on the course outline.

ASL TUTORING:

Being tutored by advanced ASL students often is very beneficial to your further learning of this visual language. Most beginning ASL students are unaccustomed to learning through a visual-manual mode. The tutors can relate to and understand your struggle. It should be noted that ASL vocabulary (semantics) and grammar (syntax) are NOT equivalent to English, as is the case with French, Spanish, and other world signed and spoken languages. It takes a while to get used to receiving language input with your eyes ONLY



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(not your ears). Tutors can also act as liaisons to your eventual socializing in Deaf Community events.

Tutoring sessions can “break the ice” for you in using your new ASL fluency. You will be able to try out conversation starters you have learned in class with your tutor, such as greetings and introductions, while communicating solely in ASL. As you progress through the semester, you can also ad-lib dialogue and have basic conversations with your tutor in ASL.

Tutors will also assist you in fine-tuning your manual articulation, with correct a) handshapes, b) palm orientation, c) points of contact, d) movements, and e) grammatical facial inflections (that use the eyebrows and mouth, for example) which are used for asking questions, adverbs, and the like.

Tutors can also assist you in preparing for quizzes and tests.

**Please review the Academic Honesty and the University Code of Conduct in
Handbook in Student Rights, Rules and Responsibilities**

<https://www.unh.edu/student-life/student-rights-rules-responsibilities>

Academic Alerts

The University is invested in your academic success. If a faculty member is concerned about your academic behavior or performance, they may submit an academic alert. Academic alerts are not punitive. The goal is to provide you with support and resources to support your success. They act as an important check-in point and, if you receive an academic alert, you will receive an email to your UNH email address. It is strongly recommended that you meet with a professional advisor and connect with your instructor to discuss the reason for the alert.

Expected Time engaged with this course.

This syllabus reflects the federal definition of a credit hour, which entails a minimum 3 hours of engaged time per week per credit over a 15-week semester. Examples of engaged time include class time, assignments, examinations, laboratories, participation in course-related experiences (attending a talk or performance, speakers and events, fieldwork, etc.), conferences, and office hours. Student work reflects intended learning outcomes and is verified through evidence of student achievement. For more information, please see:

[Pp111 Policy On Credits-And-Degrees.pdf \(neche.org\)](#)

This means a 4-credit course is designed to average 12 hours of engaged time per week – including class time.

Academic Integrity - Please review:

[University Academic Integrity Policy](#) and the [tutorial on plagiarism](#)

Artificial Intelligence Automated Writing Tools – We strongly encourage your writing to be your own – unassisted by AI. Your self-generated writing gives us a clear picture of your actual abilities. As professional interpreters, there may be times you are asked to translate from ASL to written English and therefore you need strong writing skills. If you choose to use AI, you must report that to your instructor. If use of AI is not reported, it will be considered plagiarism.

Attendance

Class attendance is important for your learning. You are responsible for all course assignments and meeting all deadlines unless exceptions are agreed upon with the instructor ahead of time. If you need to miss class for a planned activity, let the instructor know ahead of time. See the [Attendance and Class Requirements](#) policy in the undergraduate catalog.



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If a student needs accommodation for a religious or cultural holiday/observance, that student is encouraged to make that request as early in the semester as possible.

If you are dealing with an unexpected, extenuating circumstance that will keep you out of class or affect your performance for more than a day or two, reach out to Lisa Enright, Assistant Dean of Student Success, at lisa.enright@unh.edu to request a letter be sent to all your faculty.

If you miss class, you are responsible for the material.

First -

- Ask for class notes from a peer
- Review materials in Canvas
- Schedule an appointment with the ASL Tutor through the Center for Academic Enrichment
<https://caetutor.unh.edu/TracWeb40/Default.html>

If you have missed several class sessions and have gotten notes and seen the tutor but are still needing further support, attend the instructor office hours or make an appointment with the instructor.

There will not be virtual/Zoom access to class unless the course is already designed as a virtual course.

Early Alerts Report

The University is invested in your academic success. If a faculty member is concerned about your academic behavior or performance, they may submit an academic alert -- particularly around Week 5 (Sept. 22-Oct 1). Academic alerts are to provide you with assistance and resources to support your success. If you receive an academic alert, you will receive an email to your UNH email address. It is strongly recommended that you meet with a professional advisor to discuss the reason for the alert.

Student Accessibility Services

According to the Americans with Disabilities Act (as amended, 2008), each student with a disability has the right to request services from UNH to accommodate his/her/their disability. If you are a student with a documented disability or believe you may have a disability that requires accommodations, please contact Student Accessibility Services (SAS) located on the Manchester campus in the Student Services Suite (Office 405A).

Accommodation letters are created by SAS with the student. Please follow-up with your instructor as soon as possible to ensure timely implementation of the identified accommodations in the letter. Faculty have an obligation to respond once they receive official notice of accommodations from SAS but are under no obligation to provide retroactive accommodations.

For more information refer to www.unh.edu/sas or contact SAS at 603.862.2607, 711 (Relay NH) or sas.office@unh.edu.

Mental Health Support –

In partnership with The Mental Health Center of Greater Manchester, UNH Manchester offers consultation visits on a walk-in basis and through telehealth appointments. Services include:

- Free confidential screening & consultation with a licensed mental health therapist.
- Referrals to mental health or substance misuse treatment. And assistance in understanding how to afford additional treatment (with or without insurance!) or find free services.

You may email: unhm.wellness@unh.edu **to make an appointment to meet with a counselor by clicking [here](#) or by using the QR codes below.**

[For in person appointments please scan this code](#)



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[For remote appointments please scan this code](#)



If you would like to connect to counseling services directly, you may do so by contacting The Greater Manchester Mental Health Center at (603) 668 - 4111.

The National Suicide Prevention Lifeline provides 24/7, free and confidential support via phone or chat for people in distress, resources for you or your loved ones, and best practices for professionals. Call (800) 273-TALK (8255).

Sexual Harassment and Rape Prevention Program (SHARPP): Provides free and confidential advocacy and direct services to survivors. (<https://www.unh.edu/sharpp>.)

Food Pantry The UNH Manchester Food Pantry, located in room 437 is open Monday through Friday from 8:00am-9:30pm. Any UNH Manchester community member can take what they need. If you have any questions please email UNHM.Foodpantry@unh.edu

Confidentiality and Mandatory Reporting of Sexual Violence or Harassment –

The University of New Hampshire at Manchester and its community are committed to assuring a safe and productive educational environment for all students. Title IX makes it clear that violence, harassment, and discrimination based on sex and gender are Civil Rights offenses subject to the same kinds of accountability and the same kinds of support applied to offenses against other protected categories such as race, national origin, and ability.

If you or someone you know has experienced sexual or relationship violence, and/or stalking and harassment, you can find the appropriate resources below:

Reporting On Campus:

- Title IX Deputy Intake Coordinator: Lisa Enright 603-641-4336. Lisa's office is located on the fourth floor in Room 439.
- UNH Manchester Security: 603-641-4124 or located in the second floor foyer

Reporting Off Campus:

- Manchester Police Department - 603-668-8711, 405 Valley St. Manchester, NH
- or your local police department

For emergencies dial 911.

Confidential Support Resources:

- YWCA, NH – 603-668-2299(24hour), 72 Concord St. Manchester, NH
- Sexual Harassment and Rape Prevention Program (SHARPP): 603-862-7233(24hour), 8 Ballard Street, Wolff House, Durham NH 03824
- The Mental Health Center of Greater Manchester: See contact information and hours above



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- 24 Hour NH Sexual Violence Hotline: 1-800-277-5570
- 24 Hour NH Domestic Violence Hotline: 1-866-644-3574

Library

The UNH Manchester librarians are available to assist you with the research process. Visit the library's website at <https://cps.unh.edu/library> to learn about library services and to search for reliable academic sources.

The links below guide you to useful online library resources:

- [Make a Research Appointment](#) with a librarian.
- Use the [Library Search Box](#) to find information.
- [Reserve a Study Room](#)
- Discover resources for [Citing Sources](#)
- Learn strategies for [Evaluating Sources](#)

ASL Club:

This is a student-run extra-curricular activity, which ASL students of all different levels can join. You are encouraged to participate in their fun-filled ASL activities outside the classroom. Club activities include fieldtrips and various Deaf community events such as bowling, church services, museum visits, and interpreted plays. This is an excellent way for you to get moral support from your advanced ASL peers as mentors and to take advantage of opportunities to practice and improve your ASL fluency in natural communication environments. High ASL fluency is not required to participate. Interpretation into spoken English will be temporarily provided by advanced interpreting students until you are able to participate in the club meetings on your own.

For more information on club meetings and activities schedule, keep an eye on the announcement or inbox via Canvas.

HOW TO FIND INFORMATION ON DIFFERENT DEAF COMMUNITY EVENTS

There are different ways you can find out about Deaf Community events:

- ASL/Deaf Community events announcement flyers via Canvas announcement.
- Facebook, by typing "Deaf," and your state/town.
- Subscribe to local Deaf Community event announcements through [Northeast Deaf Hard of Hearing Services](#).

It is strongly recommended that you plan to attend events well in advance. This advanced planning gives students time to arrange carpools to these gatherings, which are often not found in your local neighborhood.

VOLUNTEER OPPORTUNITY:

Needless to say, while your classroom attendance/participation is an excellent opportunity to learn the visual-gestural language of the Deaf Community, to really enculturate well, one has to "be raised in the Deaf village," so to speak. This comes from knowing, not only intellectually but instinctively, the norms and values of the Deaf Community. Cultural learning is intertwined with the language being studied.



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From time to time, there are opportunities for you to volunteer with Deaf-related organizations and/or agencies and spend time within the Deaf Community. I will announce in class short-term opportunities (e.g. weekend, for a few days, and the like). If you are interested and want to make the short-term commitment, you are responsible for contacting the organization with the information given.

In addition, if you find volunteer opportunities yourself within the Deaf Community, please see me so that I can approve your volunteer placement. Monitoring of your participation will be based upon either submission of a short report or a private meeting with me. If needed, an interpreter will be provided. It is with sincere hope you will see how norms, values, and language come together as you progress in the American Sign Language class.

TENTATIVE SCHEDULE in Canvas (any changes will be announced)

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